Gatton College of Business and Economics

UK ONLINE
UNIVERSITY OF KENTUCKY.

CFP BOARD

The CFP® advantage: why it's smart to start now

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Why this career

- **The work:** you sit down with a family and work out their retirement, taxes, insurance and estate. It isn't picking stocks.
- **The pay:** the median personal financial advisor earned $105,070 in 2025.
- **The openings:** about 17,100 a year.
- **Your major works:** about half of UK alumni in wealth management didn't major in finance. Firms need people who can find and keep clients as well as build plans.
- **The upside:** about one in four of our alumni in the field has a title like partner, principal or owner.

Pay and openings: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook. Alumni: UK CFP alumni directory, November 2026.

Why a CFP®? The credential for wealth management

What it is

- A comprehensive financial planning credential (not a license)
- Covers tax, investments, retirement, estate, insurance, ethics
- The industry standard for holistic financial planning

The four requirements (“the 4 E’s”)

- **Education:** the coursework. UK’s certificate.
- **Examination:** one 6-hour exam
- **Experience:** 6,000 hours, about three years of work
- **Ethics:** background check and a fiduciary commitment

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One of the four, done before you graduate

The certificate is the Education piece. The other three come after.

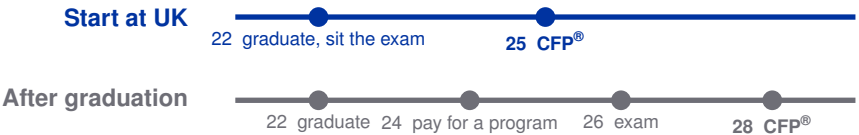
Why start now? Time is money

Start at UK

- Education done by graduation, at no extra tuition
- Exam right after graduation
- Experience in your first job

Start after graduation

- Work two years, then pay $6,000 to $10,000 for a separate program
- Education at night, then the exam
- Experience still to do



Same credential, three years and several thousand dollars apart. Six courses, 18 credits, in the slots your free electives would take.

Program details

Typical path

First semester	FIN 350 Fundamentals of Financial Planning online; fall and spring, so January works ACC 357 Tax Planning
Second	ACC 457 Estate Planning FIN 357 Investment Planning
Third	FIN 358 Risk, Insurance & Retirement
Fourth	FIN 359 Financial Plan Development (capstone)

See the plan for your major:
willgerken.com/roadmaps

- **Only requirement:** 60 credit hours earned or in progress. This fall's hours count.
- Any major. No application.
- Taught by faculty and by practicing planners
- Online, with in-person options
- Aligned with the CFP Board curriculum
- Job shadowing with CFP® professionals

Start this spring

Registration opens November 9

- If you'll have 60 credit hours by spring, put **FIN 350** in your cart
- Add the certificate in **myGPS**

Under 60 hours, or any question

- Email me: **will.gerken@uky.edu**. A few sophomores start a year early.

Remember

- No extra tuition: it uses credits you're already paying for
- The best time to start is today

Scan for the certificate page

gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning